

Qualification Pack



Usta Craft Artisan

QP Code: HCS/Q2913

Version: 1.0

NSQF Level: 4

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HCS/Q2913: Usta Craft Artisan

Brief Job Description

An Usta craft artisan from Bikaner is skilled in decorating walls, wood, camel leather, etc. using colourful painting and gold metal embossing. Their work is known for raised designs, fine detail, and a rich golden finish.

Personal Attributes

Usta artisans are known for their patience, attention to detail, and artistic flair. They possess a steady hand, a strong sense of colour and design, and a deep dedication to preserving their traditional craft with care and precision.

Applicable National Occupational Standards (NOS)

Compulsory NOS:

1. [HCS/N2915: Introduction to Usta or Gesso Painting](#)
2. [HCS/N2914: Tools, Materials & Base Surfaces in Usta Painting](#)
3. [HCS/N2917: Identify and Understand Design Motifs and Patterns in Usta Painting](#)
4. [HCS/N2916: Traditional and Contemporary Techniques of Usta Painting](#)
5. [HCS/N2918: Understand the Process of Product Development in Usta Painting](#)
6. [HCS/N2919: Quality Standards and Packaging in Usta Painting](#)
7. [HCS/N2920: Sustainability and Waste management in Usta Painting](#)
8. [HCS/N2913: Entrepreneurship skills for Usta Craft Artisan](#)
9. [HCS/N9901: Coordinate with colleagues and work as a team](#)
10. [DGT/VSQ/N0101: Employability Skills \(30 Hours\)](#)

Qualification Pack (QP) Parameters

Sector	Handicrafts and Carpet
Sub-Sector	Metalware

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Occupation	Metal Craft Making
Country	India
NSQF Level	4
Credits	13
Aligned to NCO/ISCO/ISIC Code	NCO-2015/7313.2200
Minimum Educational Qualification & Experience	12th grade Pass with NA of experience OR 8th grade pass with 1.5 years of experience OR 5th grade pass with 3 Years of experience OR Ability to read and write with 5 Years of experience OR Previous relevant Qualification of NSQF Level (3.5) with 1.5 years of experience
Minimum Level of Education for Training in School	
Pre-Requisite License or Training	NA
Minimum Job Entry Age	16 Years
Last Reviewed On	NA
Next Review Date	11/12/2028
NSQC Approval Date	11/12/2025
Version	1.0
Reference code on NQR	QG-04-HC-04691-2025-V1-HCSSC
NQR Version	1

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HCS/N2915: Introduction to Usta or Gesso Painting

Description

This unit introduces the traditional art of Usta painting, focusing on its rich heritage, characteristic use of gold embossing, and the selection and preparation of materials to create intricate decorative designs.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Understand the Essence of Usta or Gesso Painting
- Explore the Historical and Cultural Relevance
- Understand the Evolution of Usta Painting Over Time
- Assess the Geographical and Economic Context of Usta Painting
- Analyse the Current State and Need for Revival

Elements and Performance Criteria

Understand the Essence of Usta or Gesso Painting

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Define Usta or Gesso painting and its key characteristics (gold embossing, floral motifs, naqashi technique, etc.).
- PC2.** Identify traditional materials used (natural pigments, gold foil, handmade brushes).
- PC3.** Recognise the aesthetic and symbolic value of the art.
- PC4.** Explain the philosophical, cultural, geographical and other influences in the motifs.
- PC5.** Distinguish Usta Painting from other Indian traditional art forms.

Explore the Historical and Cultural Relevance

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC6.** Describe the origins and development of Usta Painting in the Bikaner region.
- PC7.** Explain how the art form evolved through a blend of regional and external artistic influences.
- PC8.** Understand the role of cultural exchange, travel, and trade relations in shaping and sustaining the tradition.
- PC9.** Discuss the importance of Usta Painting in architectural embellishment and heritage sites.
- PC10.** Examine how Usta Painting came to be associated with refined aesthetic values and cultural significance across different regions.

Understand the Evolution of Usta Painting Over Time

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC11.** Trace the migration and settlement of Usta Painting artisans in Bikaner.
- PC12.** Discuss how materials, tools, and techniques have changed over time.
- PC13.** Analyse the impact of modernity and colonial periods on Usta Painting.
- PC14.** Compare historical and contemporary applications (walls vs. wooden/metal artefacts)
- PC15.** Understand the intergenerational transfer of knowledge within artisan families.

Assess the Geographical and Economic Context of Usta Painting

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To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC16.** Locate Bikaner and surrounding areas where Usta Painting originated and continues to thrive.
- PC17.** Analyse the role of desert geography and local resources in shaping artistic techniques.
- PC18.** Understand the livelihood model of artisan communities in Bikaner and nearby regions.
- PC19.** Evaluate current challenges faced by artisans (low income, reduced demand, migration).
- PC20.** Identify potential markets, local tourism opportunities, and export prospects.

Analyse the Current State and Need for Revival

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC21.** Describe the present condition of Usta Painting and its artisan communities
- PC22.** Identify ongoing threats (mass production and low awareness).
- PC23.** Explore the role of government, Master artisans, and craft clusters in revival efforts.
- PC24.** Suggest methods for promoting Usta Painting through exhibitions, digital platforms, and education.
- PC25.** Recognise the importance of preserving Usta Painting as intangible cultural heritage

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** Basic idea of what traditional Indian art is.
- KU2.** Knowledge about Rajasthan and its culture.
- KU3.** Simple understanding of how art has been used in old buildings.
- KU4.** Awareness of how artists often pass their skills from one generation to the next.
- KU5.** Knowing that art uses materials like natural colours and handmade brushes.
- KU6.** Basic knowledge of common art patterns like flowers and leaves.
- KU7.** Understanding that art can have cultural or spiritual meanings.
- KU8.** Awareness of how trade and travel brought new styles to Indian art.
- KU9.** Knowing that some art forms are found only in certain regions.
- KU10.** Understanding that Usta Painting is different from other art styles in India.
- KU11.** Knowing that Indian art was influenced by Mughal and colonial history.
- KU12.** Some idea about how art can be used on walls, wood, or metal items.
- KU13.** Some idea about how art can be used on walls, wood, or metal items.
- KU14.** Knowledge of government schemes to support artisans.
- KU15.** Knowing that digital platforms like websites or social media can help promote art.
- KU16.** Understanding that preserving art helps protect our history and identity.
- KU17.** Knowing that Bikaner is a famous place for this kind of painting.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

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- GS1.** Interest in learning about traditional arts and culture.
- GS2.** Ability to observe and talk about colours, shapes, and patterns.
- GS3.** Good listening and willingness to learn from experienced artists.
- GS4.** Respect for cultural practices and traditions.
- GS5.** Ability to ask questions and share ideas in a group.
- GS6.** Comfort with basic drawing or painting (optional, but helpful).
- GS7.** Able to take simple notes and organise what they learn.
- GS8.** Working well in groups and showing teamwork.
- GS9.** Thinking creatively about how to solve small problems.
- GS10.** Thinking creatively about how to solve small problems.
- GS11.** Ability to notice small details in designs or artwork.
- GS12.** Sharing thoughts clearly with others through speaking or writing.
- GS13.** Willingness to visit local art centres or museums if needed.
- GS14.** Some experience using a mobile phone or computer to explore or share art.
- GS15.** Ability to compare old and new styles of art.
- GS16.** Being open to feedback and ready to improve.
- GS17.** Time management during projects or hands-on work.
- GS18.** Curious to learn about the history behind different designs.
- GS19.** Understanding that artists need support to continue their work.
- GS20.** Willingness to explore how traditional art can be made popular again.
- GS21.** Taking care while handling art materials or heritage items.

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Understand the Essence of Usta or Gesso Painting</i>	15	5	-	-
PC1. Define Usta or Gesso painting and its key characteristics (gold embossing, floral motifs, naqashi technique, etc.).	3	1	-	-
PC2. Identify traditional materials used (natural pigments, gold foil, handmade brushes).	3	1	-	-
PC3. Recognise the aesthetic and symbolic value of the art.	3	1	-	-
PC4. Explain the philosophical, cultural, geographical and other influences in the motifs.	3	1	-	-
PC5. Distinguish Usta Painting from other Indian traditional art forms.	3	1	-	-
<i>Explore the Historical and Cultural Relevance</i>	15	5	-	-
PC6. Describe the origins and development of Usta Painting in the Bikaner region.	3	1	-	-
PC7. Explain how the art form evolved through a blend of regional and external artistic influences.	3	1	-	-
PC8. Understand the role of cultural exchange, travel, and trade relations in shaping and sustaining the tradition.	3	1	-	-
PC9. Discuss the importance of Usta Painting in architectural embellishment and heritage sites.	3	1	-	-
PC10. Examine how Usta Painting came to be associated with refined aesthetic values and cultural significance across different regions.	3	1	-	-
<i>Understand the Evolution of Usta Painting Over Time</i>	15	5	-	-
PC11. Trace the migration and settlement of Usta Painting artisans in Bikaner.	3	1	-	-
PC12. Discuss how materials, tools, and techniques have changed over time.	3	1	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC13. Analyse the impact of modernity and colonial periods on Usta Painting.	3	1	-	-
PC14. Compare historical and contemporary applications (walls vs. wooden/metal. artefacts)	3	1	-	-
PC15. Understand the intergenerational transfer of knowledge within artisan families.	3	1	-	-
<i>Assess the Geographical and Economic Context of Usta Painting</i>	15	5	-	-
PC16. Locate Bikaner and surrounding areas where Usta Painting originated and continues to thrive.	3	1	-	-
PC17. Analyse the role of desert geography and local resources in shaping artistic techniques.	3	1	-	-
PC18. Understand the livelihood model of artisan communities in Bikaner and nearby regions.	3	1	-	-
PC19. Evaluate current challenges faced by artisans (low income, reduced demand, migration).	3	1	-	-
PC20. Identify potential markets, local tourism opportunities, and export prospects.	3	1	-	-
<i>Analyse the Current State and Need for Revival</i>	15	5	-	-
PC21. Describe the present condition of Usta Painting and its artisan communities	3	1	-	-
PC22. Identify ongoing threats (mass production and low awareness).	3	1	-	-
PC23. Explore the role of government, Master artisans, and craft clusters in revival efforts.	3	1	-	-
PC24. Suggest methods for promoting Usta Painting through exhibitions, digital platforms, and education.	3	1	-	-
PC25. Recognise the importance of preserving Usta Painting as intangible cultural heritage	3	1	-	-
NOS Total	75	25	-	-

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HCS/N2915
NOS Name	Introduction to Usta or Gesso Painting
Sector	Handicrafts and Carpet
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Metal Craft Making
NSQF Level	4
Credits	1
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	11/12/2025
Next Review Date	11/12/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	11/12/2025

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HCS/N2914: Tools, Materials & Base Surfaces in Usta Painting

Description

This unit covers identification and use of traditional tools and materials in Usta Painting, including natural pigments and gold leaf. It explains preparation and selection of traditional and modern base surfaces like camel leather, wood, metal, and glass. Safe handling, storage, workspace cleanliness, eco-friendly disposal, and inventory management are also emphasized for effective and responsible practice.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Identification of traditional tools and materials
- Understanding Base Surfaces for Usta Work
- Safe Handling and Storage

Elements and Performance Criteria

Identification of traditional tools and materials

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** List and describe traditional tools used in Usta Painting, such as handmade brushes, Pencils, design transfer papers/ tracing papers, embossing tools, sanding papers and laveling tools.
- PC2.** Identify key materials including natural pigments, gold leaf, adhesive (arabic gum), and animal glue.
- PC3.** Distinguish between natural and synthetic alternatives currently used by artisans.
- PC4.** Demonstrate knowledge of mixing and preparing pigments for different surfaces.

Understanding Base Surfaces for Usta Work

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC5.** Identify traditional surfaces used for Usta painting such as walls, wooden panels, and camel leather.
- PC6.** Describe preparation techniques for different base materials before applying art.
- PC7.** Understand the suitability of modern surfaces like metal, glass, MDF, and ceramics.
- PC8.** Compare the aesthetic and durability outcomes on different base types.
- PC9.** Select appropriate base surfaces based on the artwork's purpose and design.

Safe Handling and Storage

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC10.** Follow safety precautions while handling sharp tools and hazardous materials.
- PC11.** Demonstrate proper ventilation and workspace cleanliness during material use.
- PC12.** Ensure safe storage of gold foil, natural pigments, and tools to avoid damage or contamination.
- PC13.** Understand the role of temperature and humidity in affecting materials during application.
- PC14.** Adhere to eco-friendly practices for disposal of waste materials.
- PC15.** Maintain inventory and labelling of tools and supplies for easy access and organisation.

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Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** Basic awareness of traditional Indian crafts and the use of handmade tools.
- KU2.** Knowing that different art forms use different materials like paints, adhesives, or natural colours.
- KU3.** Awareness that brushes can be handmade and come in various shapes and sizes.
- KU4.** Understanding that gold leaf and natural pigments are precious and need to be handled carefully.
- KU5.** Knowing that art can be done on various surfaces like wood, leather, or walls.
- KU6.** Awareness that tracing or transferring a design is part of traditional art methods.
- KU7.** Understanding that synthetic (chemical) colours and adhesives are also used today.
- KU8.** Knows that safety is important while using sharp or strong-smelling materials.
- KU9.** Awareness of basic cleanliness while working with materials.
- KU10.** Understanding that extreme temperatures or dampness can affect art quality.
- KU11.** Knows that materials like gold foil and glue need to be stored properly.
- KU12.** Awareness of how waste should be disposed of in an eco-friendly way.
- KU13.** Understanding that keeping tools labelled and organised saves time and prevents mistakes.
- KU14.** Knowing that artists often choose their surface based on the type of art they want to create.
- KU15.** Knows that artists often choose their surface based on the type of art they want to create.
- KU16.** Awareness that camel leather is a traditional surface in Usta painting.
- KU17.** Understanding that some surfaces like glass or metal are now used in modern Usta art.
- KU18.** Awareness that good surface choice impacts how long the artwork lasts.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Ability to identify and name common tools used in simple crafts.
- GS2.** Curious and eager to learn about traditional painting materials.
- GS3.** Basic hand control and care when using pencils, brushes, or sharp objects.
- GS4.** Ability to follow safety instructions and work responsibly.
- GS5.** Willingness to keep the workspace neat and tidy.
- GS6.** Organised in managing small items like brushes, pigments, and tracing sheets.
- GS7.** Ready to ask questions and learn proper handling of materials.
- GS8.** Able to compare materials by look, feel, or performance.
- GS9.** Good observation skills to notice texture or finish on different surfaces.
- GS10.** Willingness to practise mixing and preparing colours.
- GS11.** Able to label items or keep a simple list of materials and tools.
- GS12.** Teamwork and patience when sharing materials in group activities.
- GS13.** Open to trying new surfaces like MDF or ceramic.

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- GS14.** Comfort in discussing differences between traditional and modern materials.
- GS15.** A sense of responsibility while using costly items like gold foil or natural dyes.
- GS16.** Able to keep sharp tools like cutters and embossing sticks safe when not in use.
- GS17.** Able to take basic care of tools to make them last longer.
- GS18.** Understanding how to avoid wastage while working on projects.
- GS19.** Able to read or understand simple labels, storage instructions, or packaging.
- GS20.** Willing to follow eco-friendly habits and reduce pollution during art making.

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Identification of traditional tools and materials</i>	8	19	-	-
PC1. List and describe traditional tools used in Usta Painting, such as handmade brushes, Pencils, design transfer papers/ tracing papers, embossing tools, sanding papers and laveling tools.	2	5	-	-
PC2. Identify key materials including natural pigments, gold leaf, adhesive (arabic gum), and animal glue.	2	5	-	-
PC3. Distinguish between natural and synthetic alternatives currently used by artisans.	2	5	-	-
PC4. Demonstrate knowledge of mixing and preparing pigments for different surfaces.	2	4	-	-
<i>Understanding Base Surfaces for Usta Work</i>	10	20	-	-
PC5. Identify traditional surfaces used for Usta painting such as walls, wooden panels, and camel leather.	2	4	-	-
PC6. Describe preparation techniques for different base materials before applying art.	2	4	-	-
PC7. Understand the suitability of modern surfaces like metal, glass, MDF, and ceramics.	2	4	-	-
PC8. Compare the aesthetic and durability outcomes on different base types.	2	4	-	-
PC9. Select appropriate base surfaces based on the artwork's purpose and design.	2	4	-	-
<i>Safe Handling and Storage</i>	13	30	-	-
PC10. Follow safety precautions while handling sharp tools and hazardous materials.	2	5	-	-
PC11. Demonstrate proper ventilation and workspace cleanliness during material use.	2	5	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC12. Ensure safe storage of gold foil, natural pigments, and tools to avoid damage or contamination.	2	5	-	-
PC13. Understand the role of temperature and humidity in affecting materials during application.	2	5	-	-
PC14. Adhere to eco-friendly practices for disposal of waste materials.	2	5	-	-
PC15. Maintain inventory and labelling of tools and supplies for easy access and organisation.	3	5	-	-
NOS Total	31	69	-	-

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HCS/N2914
NOS Name	Tools, Materials & Base Surfaces in Usta Painting
Sector	Handicrafts and Carpet
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Metal Craft Making
NSQF Level	4
Credits	1
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	11/12/2025
Next Review Date	11/12/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	11/12/2025

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HCS/N2917: Identify and Understand Design Motifs and Patterns in Usta Painting

Description

This unit covers the identification and interpretation of design motifs and patterns in Usta Painting, with emphasis on Mughal architectural elements like paisleys, arches, and medallions. It explores cultural symbolism, Persian and Rajasthani influences, and the evolution of motifs through different architectural periods. It includes floral, geometric, and natural inspirations, sketching and design planning techniques, and adapting motifs for various surfaces and purposes while maintaining traditional authenticity and visual harmony.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Understanding Mughal architect Motifs
- Floral, Geometric, and other Inspirations
- Drawing and Planning Designs
- Adapting Designs for Different Surfaces and Purposes

Elements and Performance Criteria

Understanding Mughal architect Motifs

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Identify common Mughal architect motifs used in Usta Painting, such as paisleys, arches, vines, and medallions.
- PC2.** Understand the symbolic meanings and cultural relevance behind traditional motifs.
- PC3.** Study the influence of Persian and Rajasthani aesthetics in Mughal architect designs.
- PC4.** Recognise the historical connection between royal Interest and Artistic demand resulted in motif evolution.
- PC5.** Apply appropriate motifs of different cultures, traditions and geographies in designs based on the artwork's purpose and context.

Floral, Geometric, and other Inspirations

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC6.** Illustrate the role of flora, fauna, and natural elements in Usta patterns.
- PC7.** Reproduce geometric forms such as symmetry, borders, and interlocking shapes.
- PC8.** Understand and respect the other symbolism in motifs used across different surfaces.
- PC9.** Integrate design inspirations while maintaining authenticity to Usta traditions.
- PC10.** Create pattern compositions that reflect balance, rhythm, and cultural relevance.

Drawing and Planning Designs

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC11.** Develop the skill to hand-sketch basic motifs and patterns accurately.
- PC12.** Translate creative ideas into quick preliminary sketches before final execution.

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- PC13.** Employ tracing and grid techniques to replicate and scale designs with precision.
- PC14.** Experiment with multiple design options through rough drafts to select the most suitable composition.
- PC15.** Maintain a sketchbook to document designs, encouraging continual improvement and creative exploration.

Adapting Designs for Different Surfaces and Purposes

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC16.** Recognise how various surfaces-such as walls, wood, leather, and metal-influence the appearance and execution of motifs.
- PC17.** Modify or simplify designs to appropriately fit the size, shape, and texture of each base material.
- PC18.** Select suitable colours and detailing that complement the characteristics of the chosen surface.
- PC19.** Plan motifs in consideration of the artwork's intended use, whether decorative, functional, or commercial.
- PC20.** Review and refine designs to ensure they are both aesthetically pleasing and durable for their specific application.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** Know about common traditional designs like paisleys, arches, flowers, vines, and circles used in Usta Painting.
- KU2.** Understand how nature like flowers, leaves, birds, and animals inspires beautiful patterns.
- KU3.** Understand which design fits best for different types of artwork and their purpose.
- KU4.** Know about simple shapes like lines, borders, and repeating patterns.
- KU5.** Know to keep the traditional look of Usta art while also trying new ideas.
- KU6.** Understand how to make a design that is balanced and pleasing to the eye.
- KU7.** Know to keep the traditional look of Usta art while also trying new ideas.
- KU8.** Know how to sketch ideas quickly before creating the final artwork.
- KU9.** Use tracing or grid techniques to copy and scale designs accurately.
- KU10.** Know to keep the traditional look of Usta art while also trying new ideas.
- KU11.** Keep a sketchbook of your drawings to improve and build creativity.
- KU12.** Know how different surfaces such as wall, wood, leather, or metal can affect the look of a design.
- KU13.** Know to keep the traditional look of Usta art while also trying new ideas.
- KU14.** Know to keep the traditional look of Usta art while also trying new ideas.
- KU15.** Know to keep the traditional look of Usta art while also trying new ideas.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

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- GS1.** Recognise and name common Usta designs and patterns.
- GS2.** Select the right type of design for each artwork or item.
- GS3.** Draw simple natural and shape-based designs clearly and neatly.
- GS4.** Use hand-drawing to show your design ideas in an organised way.
- GS5.** Use tracing paper or grids to copy and scale patterns accurately.
- GS6.** Try out different design options and choose the most suitable one.
- GS7.** Arrange patterns in a balanced and attractive layout.
- GS8.** Adjust your design depending on the surface like wall, wood, leather, or metal.
- GS9.** Choose colours that match the surface and purpose of the design.
- GS10.** Keep a sketchbook to collect your drawings and improve over time.
- GS11.** Think about how the design will be used before finalising it.
- GS12.** Check your work carefully and make changes to improve it.
- GS13.** Finish your artwork within the time given and in a tidy manner.
- GS14.** Explain your design ideas clearly to others when needed.
- GS15.** Use traditional Usta styles respectfully while exploring new creative ideas.

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Understanding Mughal architect Motifs</i>	10	15	-	-
PC1. Identify common Mughal architect motifs used in Usta Painting, such as paisleys, arches, vines, and medallions.	2	3	-	-
PC2. Understand the symbolic meanings and cultural relevance behind traditional motifs.	2	3	-	-
PC3. Study the influence of Persian and Rajasthani aesthetics in Mughal architect designs.	2	3	-	-
PC4. Recognise the historical connection between royal Interest and Artistic demand resulted in motif evolution.	2	3	-	-
PC5. Apply appropriate motifs of different cultures, traditions and geographies in designs based on the artwork's purpose and context.	2	3	-	-
<i>Floral, Geometric, and other Inspirations</i>	10	15	-	-
PC6. Illustrate the role of flora, fauna, and natural elements in Usta patterns.	2	3	-	-
PC7. Reproduce geometric forms such as symmetry, borders, and interlocking shapes.	2	3	-	-
PC8. Understand and respect the other symbolism in motifs used across different surfaces.	2	3	-	-
PC9. Integrate design inspirations while maintaining authenticity to Usta traditions.	2	3	-	-
PC10. Create pattern compositions that reflect balance, rhythm, and cultural relevance.	2	3	-	-
<i>Drawing and Planning Designs</i>	10	15	-	-
PC11. Develop the skill to hand-sketch basic motifs and patterns accurately.	2	3	-	-
PC12. Translate creative ideas into quick preliminary sketches before final execution.	2	3	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC13. Employ tracing and grid techniques to replicate and scale designs with precision.	2	3	-	-
PC14. Experiment with multiple design options through rough drafts to select the most suitable composition.	2	3	-	-
PC15. Maintain a sketchbook to document designs, encouraging continual improvement and creative exploration.	2	3	-	-
<i>Adapting Designs for Different Surfaces and Purposes</i>	10	15	-	-
PC16. Recognise how various surfaces-such as walls, wood, leather, and metal-influence the appearance and execution of motifs.	2	3	-	-
PC17. Modify or simplify designs to appropriately fit the size, shape, and texture of each base material.	2	3	-	-
PC18. Select suitable colours and detailing that complement the characteristics of the chosen surface.	2	3	-	-
PC19. Plan motifs in consideration of the artwork's intended use, whether decorative, functional, or commercial.	2	3	-	-
PC20. Review and refine designs to ensure they are both aesthetically pleasing and durable for their specific application.	2	3	-	-
NOS Total	40	60	-	-

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HCS/N2917
NOS Name	Identify and Understand Design Motifs and Patterns in Usta Painting
Sector	Handicrafts and Carpet
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Metal Craft Making
NSQF Level	4
Credits	2
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	11/12/2025
Next Review Date	11/12/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	11/12/2025

Qualification Pack

HCS/N2916: Traditional and Contemporary Techniques of Usta Painting

Description

This unit covers comprehensive training in Usta painting, focusing on surface preparation, traditional naqqashi and embossing techniques, gold foil application, fine painting and finishing, and adapting designs to modern surfaces and products. Emphasis is placed on preserving traditional aesthetics while incorporating contemporary tools and mediums.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Surface Preparation
- Naqqashi and Embossing Process
- Use of Gold Foil and Painting
- Outlining and Finishing
- Adapting Designs to New Mediums

Elements and Performance Criteria

Surface Preparation

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Clean and level the base surface to ensure it is free from dust and irregularities.
- PC2.** Apply traditional or modern primers to prepare the surface for sketching.
- PC3.** Transfer or draw initial design motifs proportionately on the primed surface.
- PC4.** Ensure accurate positioning and alignment of motifs based on the design layout.
- PC5.** Allow sufficient drying time for each preparatory layer before proceeding.

Naqqashi and Embossing Process

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC6.** Prepare the embossing paste using chalk powder, adhesive gum, and other ingredients.
- PC7.** Apply the paste precisely over outlined areas to create raised designs.
- PC8.** Use appropriate tools to sculpt fine details in the embossing while still wet.
- PC9.** Maintain uniform height and texture in embossed sections for aesthetic balance.
- PC10.** Allow the embossing to dry thoroughly to prevent cracks and damage.

Use of Gold Foil and Painting

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC11.** Handle gold foil with care using traditional methods to avoid tearing or waste.
- PC12.** Apply adhesive evenly over the embossed areas before placing gold foil.
- PC13.** Press and fix the gold foil gently using specialised tools.
- PC14.** Use natural or synthetic colours to paint background and motifs with precision.
- PC15.** Maintain colour harmony and detailing in accordance with traditional styles.

Outlining and Finishing

Qualification Pack

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC16.** Use Siyāhi (black ink) to create bold outlines around motifs and design elements.
- PC17.** Enhance fine detailing and visual depth through accurate brushwork.
- PC18.** Conduct quality checks for uniformity, symmetry, and consistency.
- PC19.** Apply polishing techniques to enhance lustre and final finish.
- PC20.** Ensure the artwork is protected from moisture and external damage through appropriate sealing.

Adapting Designs to New Mediums

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC21.** Identify emerging surfaces such as ceramics, metal, leather, and MDF for Usta application.
- PC22.** Modify traditional motifs for varied formats like souvenirs, home décor, and fashion accessories.
- PC23.** Scale and adjust designs without compromising on detail or artistic integrity.
- PC24.** Use digital tools or tracing techniques to simplify complex design transfers.
- PC25.** Maintain coherence between traditional aesthetics and contemporary utility.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** Understand the importance of cleaning and levelling the base surface before starting work.
- KU2.** Know different types of primers (traditional and modern) and their role in surface preparation.
- KU3.** Know how to draw or transfer motifs in proportion onto primed surfaces.
- KU4.** Understand alignment techniques to position design elements accurately.
- KU5.** Know drying times and layering sequence for base preparations.
- KU6.** Understand the ingredients (e.g. chalk powder, gum) and proportions for making embossing paste.
- KU7.** Know how to apply and sculpt embossing paste to maintain uniform height and texture.
- KU8.** Understand how to prevent cracks or damage in embossed areas through proper drying.
- KU9.** Know how to draw or transfer motifs in proportion onto primed surfaces.
- KU10.** Understand the use of adhesives and pressure techniques for applying gold foil.
- KU11.** Know the types of colours used (natural or synthetic) and their application techniques.
- KU12.** Understand colour harmony and how to maintain traditional aesthetics while painting.
- KU13.** Know the purpose and use of Siyahi (black ink) for outlining designs.
- KU14.** Know how to draw or transfer motifs in proportion onto primed surfaces.
- KU15.** Understand how to adapt traditional motifs for modern formats like home decor and accessories.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

Qualification Pack

- GS1.** Clean and level surfaces thoroughly before beginning artwork.
- GS2.** Apply primers evenly to create a proper base for sketching.
- GS3.** Draw initial motifs in proportion and alignment based on design layout.
- GS4.** Mix embossing paste with correct consistency and apply precisely to create raised designs.
- GS5.** Use tools skilfully to shape and refine embossed details.
- GS6.** Maintain even texture and height in embossed areas for a balanced look.
- GS7.** Allow each layer and embossing section to dry completely before continuing.
- GS8.** Handle and apply gold foil carefully to avoid waste and damage.
- GS9.** Paint background and motifs with neat brushwork and attention to colour blending.
- GS10.** Use Siyahi confidently for clear outlines and depth enhancement.
- GS11.** Perform regular checks to ensure symmetry and uniformity in artwork.
- GS12.** Polish the finished piece to enhance lustre and smoothness.
- GS13.** Seal the artwork appropriately to protect it from moisture and damage.
- GS14.** Adjust designs skilfully for different surfaces like wood, leather, or metal.
- GS15.** Use tracing or digital methods to simplify complex design transfers while retaining traditional features.

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Surface Preparation</i>	5	15	-	-
PC1. Clean and level the base surface to ensure it is free from dust and irregularities.	1	3	-	-
PC2. Apply traditional or modern primers to prepare the surface for sketching.	1	3	-	-
PC3. Transfer or draw initial design motifs proportionately on the primed surface.	1	3	-	-
PC4. Ensure accurate positioning and alignment of motifs based on the design layout.	1	3	-	-
PC5. Allow sufficient drying time for each preparatory layer before proceeding.	1	3	-	-
<i>Naqqashi and Embossing Process</i>	5	15	-	-
PC6. Prepare the embossing paste using chalk powder, adhesive gum, and other ingredients.	1	3	-	-
PC7. Apply the paste precisely over outlined areas to create raised designs.	1	3	-	-
PC8. Use appropriate tools to sculpt fine details in the embossing while still wet.	1	3	-	-
PC9. Maintain uniform height and texture in embossed sections for aesthetic balance.	1	3	-	-
PC10. Allow the embossing to dry thoroughly to prevent cracks and damage.	1	3	-	-
<i>Use of Gold Foil and Painting</i>	5	15	-	-
PC11. Handle gold foil with care using traditional methods to avoid tearing or waste.	1	3	-	-
PC12. Apply adhesive evenly over the embossed areas before placing gold foil.	1	3	-	-
PC13. Press and fix the gold foil gently using specialised tools.	1	3	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC14. Use natural or synthetic colours to paint background and motifs with precision.	1	3	-	-
PC15. Maintain colour harmony and detailing in accordance with traditional styles.	1	3	-	-
<i>Outlining and Finishing</i>	5	15	-	-
PC16. Use Siyāhi (black ink) to create bold outlines around motifs and design elements.	1	3	-	-
PC17. Enhance fine detailing and visual depth through accurate brushwork.	1	3	-	-
PC18. Conduct quality checks for uniformity, symmetry, and consistency.	1	3	-	-
PC19. Apply polishing techniques to enhance lustre and final finish.	1	3	-	-
PC20. Ensure the artwork is protected from moisture and external damage through appropriate sealing.	1	3	-	-
<i>Adapting Designs to New Mediums</i>	5	15	-	-
PC21. Identify emerging surfaces such as ceramics, metal, leather, and MDF for Usta application.	1	3	-	-
PC22. Modify traditional motifs for varied formats like souvenirs, home décor, and fashion accessories.	1	3	-	-
PC23. Scale and adjust designs without compromising on detail or artistic integrity.	1	3	-	-
PC24. Use digital tools or tracing techniques to simplify complex design transfers.	1	3	-	-
PC25. Maintain coherence between traditional aesthetics and contemporary utility.	1	3	-	-
NOS Total	25	75	-	-

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HCS/N2916
NOS Name	Traditional and Contemporary Techniques of Usta Painting
Sector	Handicrafts and Carpet
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Metal Craft Making
NSQF Level	4
Credits	2
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	11/12/2025
Next Review Date	11/12/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	11/12/2025

Qualification Pack

HCS/N2918: Understand the Process of Product Development in Usta Painting

Description

This unit covers the complete process of developing traditional and contemporary Usta painting products. It includes identifying traditional artefacts, preparing various surfaces, executing embossing and gold foil work, and adapting designs to modern formats like jewellery, home decor, and accessories. Emphasis is placed on workflow planning, quality execution, and preserving traditional aesthetics in functional, market-ready products.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Understanding Traditional and Contemporary Product Formats
- Process of Developing Contemporary Usta Products
- Product Development Workflow and Quality Execution

Elements and Performance Criteria

Understanding Traditional and Contemporary Product Formats

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Identify traditional Usta Painting artefacts such as itr-daan, shields, panels, wooden chests, and box lids with precision.
- PC2.** Analyse the form, structure, and surface suitability of each traditional product format.
- PC3.** Understand technical constraints and surface preparation techniques specific to each object.
- PC4.** Distinguish between utility-based and ornamental items in terms of design and functionality.
- PC5.** Reproduce traditional artefacts using correct layering, embossing, and finishing techniques with historical accuracy.

Process of Developing Contemporary Usta Products

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC6.** Select modern base surfaces including MDF, acrylic, resin, metal, fabric, and treated glass suitable for Usta work.
- PC7.** Prepare surfaces through sanding, priming, and base sketching to ensure durability and motif accuracy.
- PC8.** Apply Naqqashi, embossing paste, and gold foil in stages, maintaining technical finesse throughout.
- PC9.** Use modern tools to adapt motifs onto functional items such as jewellery, mirror frames, trays, apparel, and accessories.
- PC10.** Integrate mixed media (threads, beads, resin finish) while preserving Usta's traditional visual identity.
- PC11.** Ensure proper drying, sealing, and final polishing of developed products for a professional-grade finish.

Product Development Workflow and Quality Execution

Qualification Pack

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC12.** Plan a design development workflow including ideation, prototyping, motif selection, and final execution.
- PC13.** Translate conceptual designs into prototypes by aligning traditional motifs with product dimensions and ergonomics.
- PC14.** Address technical challenges such as curved surfaces, variable textures, and product balance.
- PC15.** Maintain uniformity in embossing height, motif spacing, and painting precision.
- PC16.** Conduct thorough finishing processes including outlining (siyahi), surface coating, and quality control before packaging.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** Understand the historical significance and types of traditional Usta artefacts such as itr-daans, shields, panels, and wooden boxes.
- KU2.** Know the form, structure, and surface suitability of various traditional product formats.
- KU3.** Know about the technical constraints related to different materials and their surface preparation.
- KU4.** Understand layering, embossing, and finishing techniques used in traditional Usta painting.
- KU5.** Recognise the key differences and similarities between traditional and contemporary product surfaces.
- KU6.** Understand surface preparation processes like sanding, priming, and sketching for modern materials.
- KU7.** Know the sequence of applying Naqqashi, embossing, gold foil, and colours for contemporary applications.
- KU8.** Understand the compatibility of Usta motifs with new product categories such as trays, accessories, and jewellery.
- KU9.** Know about the technical constraints related to different materials and their surface preparation.
- KU10.** Understand the importance of proper drying, sealing, and polishing for a professional finish.
- KU11.** Know the stages of product development ideation, motif selection, prototyping, and final execution.
- KU12.** Understand ergonomics and scale while applying motifs to different objects.
- KU13.** Know about the technical constraints related to different materials and their surface preparation.
- KU14.** Know about the technical constraints related to different materials and their surface preparation.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Identify and name different traditional Usta products accurately.

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- GS2.** Analyse the suitability of various surfaces for Usta work in both traditional and modern contexts.
- GS3.** Prepare surfaces through cleaning, sanding, and priming for sketching and design transfer.
- GS4.** Reproduce traditional artefacts using correct methods that reflect historical authenticity.
- GS5.** Reproduce traditional artefacts using correct methods that reflect historical authenticity.
- GS6.** Select appropriate contemporary materials such as MDF, metal, or fabric for product innovation.
- GS7.** Apply Naqqashi, embossing, and gold foil using proper sequence and neatness.
- GS8.** Use tools effectively to adapt motifs onto functional items such as home decor, apparel, and accessories.
- GS9.** Integrate mixed media elements creatively while maintaining Usta aesthetics.
- GS10.** Ensure durability of final products through sealing, drying, and polishing.
- GS11.** Plan and manage a complete product development workflow from concept to execution.
- GS12.** Translate ideas into physical prototypes while adjusting for product shape and surface.
- GS13.** Translate ideas into physical prototypes while adjusting for product shape and surface.
- GS14.** Tackle technical challenges in product design, such as non-flat or uneven surfaces.
- GS15.** Maintain uniformity in motif spacing, embossing height, and detailing across the product.
- GS16.** Perform high-quality finishing, including outlining, surface treatment, and final inspection.
- GS17.** Package finished items securely and professionally to prevent damage and maintain presentation quality.

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Understanding Traditional and Contemporary Product Formats</i>	10	20	-	-
PC1. Identify traditional Usta Painting artefacts such as itr-daan, shields, panels, wooden chests, and box lids with precision.	2	4	-	-
PC2. Analyse the form, structure, and surface suitability of each traditional product format.	2	4	-	-
PC3. Understand technical constraints and surface preparation techniques specific to each object.	2	4	-	-
PC4. Distinguish between utility-based and ornamental items in terms of design and functionality.	2	4	-	-
PC5. Reproduce traditional artefacts using correct layering, embossing, and finishing techniques with historical accuracy.	2	4	-	-
<i>Process of Developing Contemporary Usta Products</i>	12	24	-	-
PC6. Select modern base surfaces including MDF, acrylic, resin, metal, fabric, and treated glass suitable for Usta work.	2	4	-	-
PC7. Prepare surfaces through sanding, priming, and base sketching to ensure durability and motif accuracy.	2	4	-	-
PC8. Apply Naqqashi, embossing paste, and gold foil in stages, maintaining technical finesse throughout.	2	4	-	-
PC9. Use modern tools to adapt motifs onto functional items such as jewellery, mirror frames, trays, apparel, and accessories.	2	4	-	-
PC10. Integrate mixed media (threads, beads, resin finish) while preserving Usta's traditional visual identity.	2	4	-	-
PC11. Ensure proper drying, sealing, and final polishing of developed products for a professional-grade finish.	2	4	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Product Development Workflow and Quality Execution</i>	10	24	-	-
PC12. Plan a design development workflow including ideation, prototyping, motif selection, and final execution.	2	4	-	-
PC13. Translate conceptual designs into prototypes by aligning traditional motifs with product dimensions and ergonomics.	2	4	-	-
PC14. Address technical challenges such as curved surfaces, variable textures, and product balance.	2	4	-	-
PC15. Maintain uniformity in embossing height, motif spacing, and painting precision.	2	6	-	-
PC16. Conduct thorough finishing processes including outlining (siyahi), surface coating, and quality control before packaging.	2	6	-	-
NOS Total	32	68	-	-

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HCS/N2918
NOS Name	Understand the Process of Product Development in Usta Painting
Sector	Handicrafts and Carpet
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Metal Craft Making
NSQF Level	4
Credits	2
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	11/12/2025
Next Review Date	11/12/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	11/12/2025

Qualification Pack

HCS/N2919: Quality Standards and Packaging in Usta Painting

Description

This unit covers quality assurance, packaging, and sustainability practices essential to Usta painting. It focuses on maintaining design clarity, consistent embossing, and flawless finishing, while identifying defects and meeting customer expectations. Learners will explore appropriate packaging techniques for various products, safe handling, storage, and transit procedures, and eco-friendly practices to ensure product durability, appeal, and market readiness.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Understanding Quality Assurance
- Packaging Methods for Different Products
- Preventing Damage During Storage and Transport
- Product Sustainability and Waste Management

Elements and Performance Criteria

Understanding Quality Assurance

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Describe the parameters of quality in Usta Painting, including clarity of design, precision in embossing, and finish.
- PC2.** Identify defects that affect the aesthetic and commercial value of the product.
- PC3.** Ensure consistency in the application of gold foil, paint, and outlining.
- PC4.** Follow quality-control measures during each stage of production.
- PC5.** Recognise the importance of customer expectations in quality evaluation.

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC6.** Packaging Methods for Different Products
- PC7.** Adapt packaging techniques based on product size, fragility, and market (for example, luxury versus souvenir).
- PC8.** Label and store items properly to ensure easy identification and protection.
- PC9.** Select environmentally friendly and cost-effective packaging solutions wherever feasible.
- PC10.** Ensure aesthetic appeal in packaging for premium or gift ready products.

Preventing Damage During Storage and Transport

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC11.** Follow safe-handling protocols to avoid damage during movement and storage.
- PC12.** Stack and store products in a moisture-free, temperature-controlled environment.
- PC13.** Implement cushioning and spacing techniques to minimise breakage.
- PC14.** Prepare products for long-distance domestic and international transit.
- PC15.** Understand documentation requirements for exports and insured shipping.

Product Sustainability and Waste Management

Qualification Pack

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC16.** Use durable materials and finishing techniques to ensure product longevity.
- PC17.** Consider cost-efficiency and scalability of product models.
- PC18.** Ensure ease of handling, storage, and packaging for wider market reach.
- PC19.** Maintain the traditional essence while ensuring product relevance in modern lifestyles.
- PC20.** Minimise material waste through efficient planning and production.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** Understand the key parameters of quality in Usta painting, including clarity of design, even embossing, and neat finishing.
- KU2.** Recognise common defects that reduce the aesthetic and market value of Usta products.
- KU3.** Know how to ensure consistency in gold foil application, colour use, and outlining techniques.
- KU4.** Understand the role of quality control at each production stage, from sketching to final sealing.
- KU5.** Understand how customer expectations influence quality benchmarks.
- KU6.** Know various types of packaging materials such as fabric wraps, bubble sheets, wooden boxes, and corrugated board.
- KU7.** Understand the need for packaging variation based on product size, shape, fragility, and market segment.
- KU8.** Know various types of packaging materials such as fabric wraps, bubble sheets, wooden boxes, and corrugated board.
- KU9.** Understand the need for packaging variation based on product size, shape, fragility, and market segment.
- KU10.** Know how to ensure consistency in gold foil application, colour use, and outlining techniques.
- KU11.** Understand how to select packaging solutions that are both eco-friendly and cost-effective.
- KU12.** Know the importance of attractive packaging for premium and gift-oriented markets.
- KU13.** Know how to ensure consistency in gold foil application, colour use, and outlining techniques.
- KU14.** Understand environmental controls such as humidity and temperature regulation for storing Usta artefacts.
- KU15.** Know the methods for cushioning and spacing to reduce the risk of breakage during transport.
- KU16.** Understand export requirements, including documentation and shipping insurance procedures.
- KU17.** Recognise the importance of sustainability, including the use of durable materials and minimising production waste.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Check the clarity and finish of each Usta piece to meet quality standards.

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- GS2.** Detect and correct defects such as misalignment, colour mismatch, or uneven embossing.
- GS3.** Apply materials like gold foil, colours, and outlines consistently and cleanly.
- GS4.** Follow quality control procedures systematically across the production process.
- GS5.** Take customer feedback into account while assessing product quality.
- GS6.** Choose appropriate packaging based on the type and fragility of the Usta product.
- GS7.** Adapt packing styles for different audiences e.g. luxury, retail, or souvenir markets.
- GS8.** Label products clearly and organise them for efficient handling and delivery.
- GS9.** Select packaging that is visually appealing, practical, and environmentally sustainable.
- GS10.** Maintain the visual appeal of packaging for gift-ready or premium items.
- GS11.** Handle and move products carefully to avoid chipping or surface damage.
- GS12.** Store items correctly to protect them from humidity, pests, or temperature damage.
- GS13.** Use cushioning techniques such as foam, padding, or compartmentalisation to protect fragile items.
- GS14.** Prepare items securely for local and international transport with correct documentation.
- GS15.** Minimise material waste by planning layouts efficiently and using leftover resources smartly.

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Understanding Quality Assurance</i>	10	15	-	-
PC1. Describe the parameters of quality in Usta Painting, including clarity of design, precision in embossing, and finish.	2	3	-	-
PC2. Identify defects that affect the aesthetic and commercial value of the product.	2	3	-	-
PC3. Ensure consistency in the application of gold foil, paint, and outlining.	2	3	-	-
PC4. Follow quality-control measures during each stage of production.	2	3	-	-
PC5. Recognise the importance of customer expectations in quality evaluation.	2	3	-	-
	10	15	-	-
PC6. Packaging Methods for Different Products	2	3	-	-
PC7. Adapt packaging techniques based on product size, fragility, and market (for example, luxury versus souvenir).	2	3	-	-
PC8. Label and store items properly to ensure easy identification and protection.	2	3	-	-
PC9. Select environmentally friendly and cost-effective packaging solutions wherever feasible.	2	3	-	-
PC10. Ensure aesthetic appeal in packaging for premium or gift ready products.	2	3	-	-
<i>Preventing Damage During Storage and Transport</i>	10	15	-	-
PC11. Follow safe-handling protocols to avoid damage during movement and storage.	2	3	-	-
PC12. Stack and store products in a moisture-free, temperature-controlled environment.	2	3	-	-
PC13. Implement cushioning and spacing techniques to minimise breakage.	2	3	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC14. Prepare products for long-distance domestic and international transit.	2	3	-	-
PC15. Understand documentation requirements for exports and insured shipping.	2	3	-	-
<i>Product Sustainability and Waste Management</i>	10	15	-	-
PC16. Use durable materials and finishing techniques to ensure product longevity.	2	3	-	-
PC17. Consider cost-efficiency and scalability of product models.	2	3	-	-
PC18. Ensure ease of handling, storage, and packaging for wider market reach.	2	3	-	-
PC19. Maintain the traditional essence while ensuring product relevance in modern lifestyles.	2	3	-	-
PC20. Minimise material waste through efficient planning and production.	2	3	-	-
NOS Total	40	60	-	-

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HCS/N2919
NOS Name	Quality Standards and Packaging in Usta Painting
Sector	Handicrafts and Carpet
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Metal Craft Making
NSQF Level	4
Credits	1
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	11/12/2025
Next Review Date	11/12/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	11/12/2025

Qualification Pack

HCS/N2920: Sustainability and Waste management in Usta Painting

Description

This unit covers sustainable practices across the Usta painting process, from raw material selection to responsible waste management. It emphasizes the use of eco-friendly tools, efficient material usage, and proper disposal methods to minimise environmental impact. Learners will explore recycling, repurposing techniques, local sourcing, and long-term maintenance strategies to reduce waste, extend the life of tools and materials, and promote environmentally responsible craftsmanship.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Understand Raw Materials and Tools Used in Usta Painting
- Minimise Waste During Preparation and Application
- Sustainable Disposal and Recycling of Waste
- Promote Eco-Friendly Practices in Material Sourcing and Usage
- Maintain Tools and Materials to Extend Lifespan

Elements and Performance Criteria

Understand Raw Materials and Tools Used in Usta Painting

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Identify the main raw materials used, including wood, metal, glass, and mud as base surfaces.
- PC2.** Recognise natural and synthetic pigments, gesso paste, gold foil (varak), and adhesives used in the craft.
- PC3.** Understand the role of tools such as brushes, embossing tools, sandpapers, and polishing stones in the painting process.
- PC4.** Appreciate the impact of material and tool selection on the sustainability of the artwork.
- PC5.** Consider sourcing materials and tools that support environmental responsibility and long-term durability.

Minimise Waste During Preparation and Application

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC6.** Plan the use of raw materials and tools to reduce excess and wastage during design transfer and painting.
- PC7.** Apply precise techniques when using gesso paste, pigments, and gold foil to limit material loss.
- PC8.** Reuse offcuts, leftover pigments, and gold foil scraps where possible in the artwork or practice work.
- PC9.** Use tools efficiently to avoid damage to materials and reduce the need for replacements.
- PC10.** Adopt best practices in mixing, applying, and storing materials to preserve their quality and minimise spoilage.

Sustainable Disposal and Recycling of Waste

Qualification Pack

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC11.** Identify types of waste generated during Usta Painting, including leftover pigments, broken tools, and excess gesso.
- PC12.** Segregate waste into recyclable, biodegradable, and non-recyclable categories.
- PC13.** Employ environmentally safe methods for disposing of chemical or synthetic waste components.
- PC14.** Explore options for recycling or repurposing waste materials within the craft or community.
- PC15.** Encourage adoption of eco-friendly alternatives to hazardous materials traditionally used in the craft.

Promote Eco-Friendly Practices in Material Sourcing and Usage

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC16.** Source materials that are locally available to reduce transportation impact and support local economy.
- PC17.** Prefer natural pigments and organic adhesives over synthetic and chemically intensive alternatives.
- PC18.** Choose tools made from sustainable or recyclable materials.
- PC19.** Ensure responsible harvesting and use of raw materials, respecting cultural and environmental balance.
- PC20.** Advocate for continuous learning and adoption of sustainable innovations in the Usta Painting process.

Maintain Tools and Materials to Extend Lifespan

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC21.** Clean and store brushes, embossing tools, and other equipment properly to prevent damage and deterioration.
- PC22.** Monitor condition of raw materials regularly and protect them from environmental damage such as moisture and dust.
- PC23.** Repair and refurbish tools and materials whenever possible to reduce waste.
- PC24.** Keep accurate inventory of materials and tools to avoid over-purchasing and expiry.
- PC25.** Train artisans on maintenance techniques to promote sustainable craftsmanship.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** Understand the base materials commonly used in Usta painting, such as wood, metal, glass, and mud.
- KU2.** Identify various natural and synthetic pigments, adhesives, gesso paste, and gold foil (varak) used in the craft.
- KU3.** Know about the role of specific tools like brushes, embossing tools, sandpapers, and polishing stones.
- KU4.** Understand how the choice of materials and tools influences the sustainability and environmental impact of the artwork.
- KU5.** Understand the importance of sourcing durable, eco-conscious materials and tools.

Qualification Pack

- KU6.** Recognise how to minimise waste during different stages of Usta painting design transfer, painting, and finishing.
- KU7.** Understand best practices in the precise use of gold foil, pigments, and gesso to avoid unnecessary wastage.
- KU8.** Know the techniques for reusing leftover materials such as pigment residues, foil scraps, and wooden offcuts.
- KU9.** Identify types of waste generated in the Usta process and understand safe disposal methods.
- KU10.** Understand waste segregation recyclable, biodegradable, and non-recyclable and its significance.
- KU11.** Recognise chemical and synthetic waste components and their proper disposal techniques.
- KU12.** Know about the role of specific tools like brushes, embossing tools, sandpapers, and polishing stones.
- KU13.** Understand the environmental and economic benefits of sourcing materials locally.
- KU14.** Know about the role of specific tools like brushes, embossing tools, sandpapers, and polishing stones.
- KU15.** Know about the role of specific tools like brushes, embossing tools, sandpapers, and polishing stones.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Identify suitable materials and tools for sustainable Usta painting practices.
- GS2.** Use raw materials thoughtfully and plan their use to minimise waste.
- GS3.** Apply gesso, gold foil, and pigments precisely to reduce overuse and spillage.
- GS4.** Reuse leftover materials efficiently in artwork, practice sessions, or community workshops.
- GS5.** Use and maintain tools correctly to prevent wear and reduce frequent replacements.
- GS6.** Mix, apply, and store materials with care to avoid spoilage and maintain quality.
- GS7.** Sort and dispose of different types of waste in an environmentally safe manner.
- GS8.** Use eco-friendly methods for managing synthetic waste and encourage their adoption.
- GS9.** Repurpose waste materials where applicable and support circular use within the craft.
- GS10.** Promote the use of local, sustainable, and recyclable tools and materials.
- GS11.** Select natural pigments and organic adhesives instead of synthetic ones where possible.
- GS12.** Clean, store, and monitor tools and materials to prevent damage and extend usage.
- GS13.** Repair or refurbish tools and surfaces rather than replacing them unnecessarily.
- GS14.** Maintain inventory records to avoid overstocking or material expiry.
- GS15.** Share knowledge and train fellow artisans in sustainable practices and innovations in Usta painting.

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Understand Raw Materials and Tools Used in Usta Painting</i>	5	15	-	-
PC1. Identify the main raw materials used, including wood, metal, glass, and mud as base surfaces.	1	3	-	-
PC2. Recognise natural and synthetic pigments, gesso paste, gold foil (varak), and adhesives used in the craft.	1	3	-	-
PC3. Understand the role of tools such as brushes, embossing tools, sandpapers, and polishing stones in the painting process.	1	3	-	-
PC4. Appreciate the impact of material and tool selection on the sustainability of the artwork.	1	3	-	-
PC5. Consider sourcing materials and tools that support environmental responsibility and long-term durability.	1	3	-	-
<i>Minimise Waste During Preparation and Application</i>	5	15	-	-
PC6. Plan the use of raw materials and tools to reduce excess and wastage during design transfer and painting.	1	3	-	-
PC7. Apply precise techniques when using gesso paste, pigments, and gold foil to limit material loss.	1	3	-	-
PC8. Reuse offcuts, leftover pigments, and gold foil scraps where possible in the artwork or practice work.	1	3	-	-
PC9. Use tools efficiently to avoid damage to materials and reduce the need for replacements.	1	3	-	-
PC10. Adopt best practices in mixing, applying, and storing materials to preserve their quality and minimise spoilage.	1	3	-	-
<i>Sustainable Disposal and Recycling of Waste</i>	5	15	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC11. Identify types of waste generated during Usta Painting, including leftover pigments, broken tools, and excess gesso.	1	3	-	-
PC12. Segregate waste into recyclable, biodegradable, and non-recyclable categories.	1	3	-	-
PC13. Employ environmentally safe methods for disposing of chemical or synthetic waste components.	1	3	-	-
PC14. Explore options for recycling or repurposing waste materials within the craft or community.	1	3	-	-
PC15. Encourage adoption of eco-friendly alternatives to hazardous materials traditionally used in the craft.	1	3	-	-
<i>Promote Eco-Friendly Practices in Material Sourcing and Usage</i>	5	15	-	-
PC16. Source materials that are locally available to reduce transportation impact and support local economy.	1	3	-	-
PC17. Prefer natural pigments and organic adhesives over synthetic and chemically intensive alternatives.	1	3	-	-
PC18. Choose tools made from sustainable or recyclable materials.	1	3	-	-
PC19. Ensure responsible harvesting and use of raw materials, respecting cultural and environmental balance.	1	3	-	-
PC20. Advocate for continuous learning and adoption of sustainable innovations in the Usta Painting process.	1	3	-	-
<i>Maintain Tools and Materials to Extend Lifespan</i>	5	15	-	-
PC21. Clean and store brushes, embossing tools, and other equipment properly to prevent damage and deterioration.	1	3	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC22. Monitor condition of raw materials regularly and protect them from environmental damage such as moisture and dust.	1	3	-	-
PC23. Repair and refurbish tools and materials whenever possible to reduce waste.	1	3	-	-
PC24. Keep accurate inventory of materials and tools to avoid over-purchasing and expiry.	1	3	-	-
PC25. Train artisans on maintenance techniques to promote sustainable craftsmanship.	1	3	-	-
NOS Total	25	75	-	-

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HCS/N2920
NOS Name	Sustainability and Waste management in Usta Painting
Sector	Handicrafts and Carpet
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Metal Craft Making
NSQF Level	4
Credits	1
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	11/12/2025
Next Review Date	11/12/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	11/12/2025

Qualification Pack

HCS/N2913: Entrepreneurship skills for Usta Craft Artisan

Description

This unit covers the essential entrepreneurship skills needed by Usta artisans to identify market opportunities, build a sustainable business, promote their craft, manage finances, and maintain customer relationships. It also emphasizes innovation, quality enhancement, and legal and ethical practices to support long-term success in the art and craft market.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Identify Business Opportunities.
- Plan and Establish a Craft Business.
- Develop Marketing Strategies.
- Manage Finances and Record-Keeping.
- Enhance Product Quality and Innovation.
- Ensure Legal Compliance and Ethical Practices.
- Ensure Legal Compliance and Ethical Practices.
- Manage Customer Relationships.

Elements and Performance Criteria

Identify Business Opportunities

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** Analyse market demand for Usta painting in various sectors such as home décor, souvenirs, or custom art.
- PC2.** Research trends in the art and craft market to identify emerging opportunities.
- PC3.** Identify potential customer segments (e.g., local buyers, tourists, interior decorators).
- PC4.** Explore niche markets or customisation options to cater to specific customer needs.
- PC5.** Evaluate local and online platforms for selling Usta paintings.

Plan and Establish a Craft Business

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC6.** Develop a basic business plan outlining objectives, products, pricing, and target market.
- PC7.** Select appropriate materials and ensure a sustainable supply chain for raw materials.
- PC8.** Set competitive yet profitable pricing for the artwork, considering material and labour costs.
- PC9.** Register the business as per legal requirements and explore government schemes or artisan support programmes.
- PC10.** Set up an efficient workspace for Usta painting production.

Develop Marketing Strategies

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC11.** Build a brand identity that reflects the authenticity of Usta painting.
- PC12.** Create marketing materials that highlight the unique qualities and cultural heritage of Usta Painting.

Qualification Pack

- PC13.** Use both offline (fairs, exhibitions) and online (social media, website) platforms to reach potential customers.
- PC14.** Offer promotions or limited-edition collections to attract new buyers.
- PC15.** Network with interior designers, art galleries, and souvenir shops to expand your customer base.

Manage Finances and Record-Keeping

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC16.** Keep a record of income and expenses to understand cash flow.
- PC17.** Develop a simple budgeting system to track production costs and profits.
- PC18.** Apply basic accounting methods to maintain financial transparency.
- PC19.** Save and reinvest a portion of profits for future business growth.
- PC20.** Understand and manage costs for raw materials, labour, and overheads.

Enhance Product Quality and Innovation

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC21.** Continuously improve the quality of the artwork by practising and experimenting with new techniques
- PC22.** Respond to customer feedback to improve the design, quality, or functionality of the artwork.
- PC23.** Stay updated with new trends in art and craft to innovate while maintaining the traditional essence of Usta painting.
- PC24.** Collaborate with other artisans or designers to create unique collections.
- PC25.** Ensure that each piece is meticulously finished and adheres to the standards of Usta Painting.

Ensure Legal Compliance and Ethical Practices

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC26.** Comply with local regulations related to business registration, taxes, and labour laws.
- PC27.** Respect the intellectual property rights associated with traditional Usta painting techniques.
- PC28.** Maintain transparent pricing, ensuring fair trade practices with customers and suppliers.
- PC29.** Use eco-friendly materials and adopt sustainable practices where possible.
- PC30.** Ensure ethical sourcing of materials, respecting cultural heritage and craftsmanship.

Manage Customer Relationships

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC31.** Offer personalised customer service and address customer inquiries promptly.
- PC32.** Build and maintain a loyal customer base by delivering high-quality products and meeting deadlines.
- PC33.** Seek feedback from customers to improve future offerings.
- PC34.** Use word-of-mouth marketing by encouraging satisfied customers to share their experiences.
- PC35.** Provide after-sales support, such as repairs or customisation, to enhance customer satisfaction.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

Qualification Pack

- KU1.** Understand the concept of entrepreneurship and its importance in the context of traditional arts and crafts.
- KU2.** Understand how to analyse market demand for Usta painting across sectors such as home decor, souvenirs, and personalised gifts.
- KU3.** Identify emerging trends in the art and craft sector to spot new business opportunities.
- KU4.** Understand different customer segments including tourists, art collectors, and interior designers.
- KU5.** Knowledge of niche markets and customisation options that enhance value.
- KU6.** Understand the components of a basic business plan objectives, pricing, product line, and customer base.
- KU7.** Knowledge of niche markets and customisation options that enhance value.
- KU8.** Knowledge of local markets, craft fairs, and online platforms suitable for Usta painting sales.
- KU9.** Understand the components of a basic business plan objectives, pricing, product line, and customer base.
- KU10.** Understand how to ensure a reliable and sustainable supply chain for materials.
- KU11.** Understand how to determine competitive yet profitable pricing by accounting for material, time, and labour costs.
- KU12.** Understand legal procedures for business registration, tax compliance, and government artisan schemes.
- KU13.** Understand brand development creating a brand identity rooted in tradition and uniqueness.
- KU14.** Understand how these marketing methods can help promote the craft to more people, increase interest, and support sales.
- KU15.** Understand how to network with businesses, art galleries, and tourism sectors.
- KU16.** Understand how to network with businesses, art galleries, and tourism sectors.
- KU17.** Knowledge of basic financial literacy including budgeting, record-keeping, and cash flow management.
- KU18.** Know and understand methods of reinvesting profits to grow and scale the business effectively.
- KU19.** Understand innovation in design while respecting the traditional aesthetics of Usta painting.
- KU20.** Learn about ethical sourcing, intellectual property, environmental sustainability, and fair-trade practices.
- KU21.** Know ethical sourcing, intellectual property, environmental sustainability, and fair-trade practices.

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** Identify and assess business opportunities for Usta paintings in different market segments.
- GS2.** Research and apply current trends to align product offerings with market demand.
- GS3.** Develop and present a practical business plan for a craft-based enterprise.
- GS4.** Select materials responsibly and manage procurement sustainably.
- GS5.** Set prices effectively to ensure profitability while remaining competitive.

Qualification Pack

- GS6.** Register a craft business and explore artisan support schemes.
- GS7.** Design effective marketing materials that highlight the cultural value of Usta painting.
- GS8.** Promote the business through both traditional and digital channels.
- GS9.** Network strategically with relevant stakeholders to increase visibility and sales.
- GS10.** Maintain financial records accurately and manage a basic budgeting system.
- GS11.** Monitor costs and track profits to ensure sustainable business operations.
- GS12.** Practise quality control and refine artwork through experimentation and feedback.
- GS13.** Practise quality control and refine artwork through experimentation and feedback.
- GS14.** Respond to customer feedback and adapt product offerings accordingly.
- GS15.** Collaborate with other creatives for innovation while preserving tradition.
- GS16.** Comply with legal and ethical standards in all aspects of the business.
- GS17.** Maintain transparent pricing and fair practices with buyers and vendors.
- GS18.** Maintain transparent pricing and fair practices with buyers and vendors.
- GS19.** Provide excellent customer service and post-sale support to build trust and loyalty.

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Identify Business Opportunities</i>	5	10	-	-
PC1. Analyse market demand for Usta painting in various sectors such as home décor, souvenirs, or custom art.	1	2	-	-
PC2. Research trends in the art and craft market to identify emerging opportunities.	1	2	-	-
PC3. Identify potential customer segments (e.g., local buyers, tourists, interior decorators).	1	2	-	-
PC4. Explore niche markets or customisation options to cater to specific customer needs.	1	2	-	-
PC5. Evaluate local and online platforms for selling Usta paintings.	1	2	-	-
<i>Plan and Establish a Craft Business</i>	5	10	-	-
PC6. Develop a basic business plan outlining objectives, products, pricing, and target market.	1	2	-	-
PC7. Select appropriate materials and ensure a sustainable supply chain for raw materials.	1	2	-	-
PC8. Set competitive yet profitable pricing for the artwork, considering material and labour costs.	1	2	-	-
PC9. Register the business as per legal requirements and explore government schemes or artisan support programmes.	1	2	-	-
PC10. Set up an efficient workspace for Usta painting production.	1	2	-	-
<i>Develop Marketing Strategies</i>	5	10	-	-
PC11. Build a brand identity that reflects the authenticity of Usta painting.	1	2	-	-
PC12. Create marketing materials that highlight the unique qualities and cultural heritage of Usta Painting.	1	2	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC13. Use both offline (fairs, exhibitions) and online (social media, website) platforms to reach potential customers.	1	2	-	-
PC14. Offer promotions or limited-edition collections to attract new buyers.	1	2	-	-
PC15. Network with interior designers, art galleries, and souvenir shops to expand your customer base.	1	2	-	-
<i>Manage Finances and Record-Keeping</i>	5	10	-	-
PC16. Keep a record of income and expenses to understand cash flow.	1	2	-	-
PC17. Develop a simple budgeting system to track production costs and profits.	1	2	-	-
PC18. Apply basic accounting methods to maintain financial transparency.	1	2	-	-
PC19. Save and reinvest a portion of profits for future business growth.	1	2	-	-
PC20. Understand and manage costs for raw materials, labour, and overheads.	1	2	-	-
<i>Enhance Product Quality and Innovation</i>	5	10	-	-
PC21. Continuously improve the quality of the artwork by practising and experimenting with new techniques	1	2	-	-
PC22. Respond to customer feedback to improve the design, quality, or functionality of the artwork.	1	2	-	-
PC23. Stay updated with new trends in art and craft to innovate while maintaining the traditional essence of Usta painting.	1	2	-	-
PC24. Collaborate with other artisans or designers to create unique collections.	1	2	-	-
PC25. Ensure that each piece is meticulously finished and adheres to the standards of Usta Painting.	1	2	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Ensure Legal Compliance and Ethical Practices</i>	5	10	-	-
PC26. Comply with local regulations related to business registration, taxes, and labour laws.	1	2	-	-
PC27. Respect the intellectual property rights associated with traditional Usta painting techniques.	1	2	-	-
PC28. Maintain transparent pricing, ensuring fair trade practices with customers and suppliers.	1	2	-	-
PC29. Use eco-friendly materials and adopt sustainable practices where possible.	1	2	-	-
PC30. Ensure ethical sourcing of materials, respecting cultural heritage and craftsmanship.	1	2	-	-
<i>Manage Customer Relationships</i>	5	5	-	-
PC31. Offer personalised customer service and address customer inquiries promptly.	1	1	-	-
PC32. Build and maintain a loyal customer base by delivering high-quality products and meeting deadlines.	1	1	-	-
PC33. Seek feedback from customers to improve future offerings.	1	1	-	-
PC34. Use word-of-mouth marketing by encouraging satisfied customers to share their experiences.	1	1	-	-
PC35. Provide after-sales support, such as repairs or customisation, to enhance customer satisfaction.	1	1	-	-
NOS Total	35	65	-	-

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HCS/N2913
NOS Name	Entrepreneurship skills for Usta Craft Artisan
Sector	Handicrafts and Carpet
Sub-Sector	
Occupation	Entrepreneur
NSQF Level	4
Credits	1
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	11/12/2025
Next Review Date	11/12/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	11/12/2025

Qualification Pack

HCS/N9901: Coordinate with colleagues and work as a team

Description

This NOS describes the communication and coordination skills and knowledge to work with colleagues and supervisor to achieve a smooth and hazard-free workflow.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- interact with supervisor or superior
- work as a team by coordinating with colleagues within and outside the department and include inputs on PwD & Gender Sensitisation
- report and Document

Elements and Performance Criteria

Interact with supervisor or superior

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC1.** comply with health, safety gender, and PwD (People with disability) related instructions applicable to the workplace
- PC2.** actively participate in mock drills/ evacuation procedures; group discussions, training sensitization programs for gender, and PwD awareness organized at the workplace.
- PC3.** receive job orders and instructions from reporting supervisor and receive feedback on work standards.
- PC4.** understand the work output requirements, targets, performance indicators and incentives.
- PC5.** deliver quality work on time and report any anticipated reasons for delays and handover completed work to supervisor
- PC6.** report on any grievances, production defects and any potential hazards.

Work as a team by coordinating with colleagues within and outside the department and include inputs on PwD & Gender Sensitisation

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC7.** communicate maintenance and repair schedule proactively to the supervisor
- PC8.** interact and clarify doubts on design, usage of materials & tools, quality & standards compliance, etc.

Report and Document

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

- PC9.** report in time for shortage or need of raw materials
- PC10.** communicate with colleagues from within and other departments, clearly and effectively on all aspects to carry out the work among the team
- PC11.** maintain the etiquette, use polite language, demonstrate responsible and disciplined behavior towards colleagues.
- PC12.** put team over individual goals and multi-task or share work where necessary supporting the colleagues.

Qualification Pack

PC13. document all the details accurately relating to ones role as required.

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

- KU1.** knowledge about the importance of gender equality being followed in the organization and policies for reporting any harassment or inappropriate behavior
- KU2.** knowledge about how to accommodate employees with disabilities etiquette to adhere to and proper language and terminology
- KU3.** knowledge about how to communicate, offer help, respecting space, parking etc. for people with disabilities or special needs
- KU4.** knowledge about promoting a safe, accessible and healthy workplace for disabled employees
- KU5.** company's policies on preferred language of communication, incentives, quality standards, personnel management, reporting and escalation matrix policy.
- KU6.** company's standard operating procedure (sop) and the risk and impact of not following them.
- KU7.** procedures for working with colleagues, his/her role and responsibilities in relation to this
- KU8.** organizational hierarchy and the line of reporting structure and work target and review mechanism
- KU9.** procedures to report employment related issues and to deal with conflicts
- KU10.** importance of the individuals role in the organizational workflow and details of the individual responsibilities
- KU11.** tools and equipment handling procedure and common potential hazards in the work place and the procedures to deal with them
- KU12.** effective communication with various categories of people and the different departments in the organization
- KU13.** to document the job activity as required like the check sheets, history sheets, etc
- KU14.** expressing and addressing grievances appropriately, deal with difficult work relationships and manage the internal conflicts effectively

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** create a positive and inclusive workplace atmosphere without any kind of bias/discrimination towards any employee
- GS2.** actively take part in any discussion/workshop organized for gender sensitization training
- GS3.** read and comprehend written instructions related to gender equality issues in the organization
- GS4.** identify and report any harassment or inappropriate behavior towards any employee
- GS5.** create a positive and inclusive workplace atmosphere without any kind of bias/discrimination towards any employee with disability or special needs
- GS6.** actively take part in any discussion/workshop organized for disability sensitization training.

Qualification Pack

- GS7.** read and comprehend written instructions related to equality issues in the organization related to disabled persons
- GS8.** read job sheets, design sheet and information displayed at the workplace
- GS9.** read and understand manuals, health and safety instructions, memos etc
- GS10.** fill up documentation to ones role
- GS11.** communicate effectively with supervisor
- GS12.** contribute to quality of team work and achieve smooth workflow
- GS13.** improve work processes by interacting with others and adopting best practices

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Interact with supervisor or superior</i>	14	30	-	-
PC1. comply with health, safety gender, and PwD (People with disability) related instructions applicable to the workplace	2	5	-	-
PC2. actively participate in mock drills/ evacuation procedures; group discussions, training sensitization programs for gender, and PwD awareness organized at the workplace.	2	5	-	-
PC3. receive job orders and instructions from reporting supervisor and receive feedback on work standards.	2	5	-	-
PC4. understand the work output requirements, targets, performance indicators and incentives.	2	5	-	-
PC5. deliver quality work on time and report any anticipated reasons for delays and handover completed work to supervisor	3	5	-	-
PC6. report on any grievances, production defects and any potential hazards.	3	5	-	-
<i>Work as a team by coordinating with colleagues within and outside the department and include inputs on PwD & Gender Sensitisation</i>	6	10	-	-
PC7. communicate maintenance and repair schedule proactively to the supervisor	3	5	-	-
PC8. interact and clarify doubts on design, usage of materials & tools, quality & standards compliance, etc.	3	5	-	-
<i>Report and Document</i>	15	25	-	-
PC9. report in time for shortage or need of raw materials	3	5	-	-
PC10. communicate with colleagues from within and other departments, clearly and effectively on all aspects to carry out the work among the team	3	5	-	-

Qualification Pack

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC11. maintain the etiquette, use polite language, demonstrate responsible and disciplined behavior towards colleagues.	3	5	-	-
PC12. put team over individual goals and multi-task or share work where necessary supporting the colleagues.	3	5	-	-
PC13. document all the details accurately relating to ones role as required.	3	5	-	-
NOS Total	35	65	-	-

Qualification Pack

National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	HCS/N9901
NOS Name	Coordinate with colleagues and work as a team
Sector	Handicrafts and Carpet
Sub-Sector	Handicrafts (Ceramics), Handicrafts (Fashion Jewellery), Handicrafts (Stonecraft), Glassware, Metalware, Carpet, Handicrafts (Woodware)
Occupation	Generic
NSQF Level	4
Credits	1
Version	6.0
Last Reviewed Date	11/12/2025
Next Review Date	11/12/2028
NSQC Clearance Date	11/12/2025

Qualification Pack

DGT/VSQ/N0101: Employability Skills (30 Hours)

Description

This unit is about employability skills, Constitutional values, becoming a professional in the 21st Century, digital, financial, and legal literacy, diversity and Inclusion, English and communication skills, customer service, entrepreneurship, and apprenticeship, getting ready for jobs and career development.

Scope

The scope covers the following :

- Introduction to Employability Skills
- Constitutional values - Citizenship
- Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century
- Basic English Skills
- Communication Skills
- Diversity & Inclusion
- Financial and Legal Literacy
- Essential Digital Skills
- Entrepreneurship
- Customer Service
- Getting ready for Apprenticeship & Jobs

Elements and Performance Criteria

Introduction to Employability Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC1. understand the significance of employability skills in meeting the job requirements

Constitutional values – Citizenship

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC2. identify constitutional values, civic rights, duties, personal values and ethics and environmentally sustainable practices

Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC3. explain 21st Century Skills such as Self-Awareness, Behavior Skills, Positive attitude, self-motivation, problem-solving, creative thinking, time management, social and cultural awareness, emotional awareness, continuous learning mindset etc.

Basic English Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC4. speak with others using some basic English phrases or sentences

Communication Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC5. follow good manners while communicating with others

PC6. work with others in a team

Qualification Pack

Diversity & Inclusion

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC7. communicate and behave appropriately with all genders and PwD

PC8. report any issues related to sexual harassment

Financial and Legal Literacy

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC9. use various financial products and services safely and securely

PC10. calculate income, expenses, savings etc.

PC11. approach the concerned authorities for any exploitation as per legal rights and laws

Essential Digital Skills

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC12. operate digital devices and use its features and applications securely and safely

PC13. use internet and social media platforms securely and safely

Entrepreneurship

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC14. identify and assess opportunities for potential business

PC15. identify sources for arranging money and associated financial and legal challenges

Customer Service

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC16. identify different types of customers

PC17. identify customer needs and address them appropriately

PC18. follow appropriate hygiene and grooming standards

Getting ready for apprenticeship & Jobs

To be competent, the user/individual on the job must be able to:

PC19. create a basic biodata

PC20. search for suitable jobs and apply

PC21. identify and register apprenticeship opportunities as per requirement

Knowledge and Understanding (KU)

The individual on the job needs to know and understand:

KU1. need for employability skills

KU2. various constitutional and personal values

KU3. different environmentally sustainable practices and their importance

KU4. Twenty first (21st) century skills and their importance

KU5. how to use basic spoken English language

KU6. Do and dont of effective communication

KU7. inclusivity and its importance

KU8. different types of disabilities and appropriate communication and behaviour towards PwD

KU9. different types of financial products and services

Qualification Pack

- KU10.** how to compute income and expenses
- KU11.** importance of maintaining safety and security in financial transactions
- KU12.** different legal rights and laws
- KU13.** how to operate digital devices and applications safely and securely
- KU14.** ways to identify business opportunities
- KU15.** types of customers and their needs
- KU16.** how to apply for a job and prepare for an interview
- KU17.** apprenticeship scheme and the process of registering on apprenticeship portal

Generic Skills (GS)

User/individual on the job needs to know how to:

- GS1.** communicate effectively using appropriate language
- GS2.** behave politely and appropriately with all
- GS3.** perform basic calculations
- GS4.** solve problems effectively
- GS5.** be careful and attentive at work
- GS6.** use time effectively
- GS7.** maintain hygiene and sanitisation to avoid infection

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Assessment Criteria

Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
<i>Introduction to Employability Skills</i>	1	1	-	-
PC1. understand the significance of employability skills in meeting the job requirements	-	-	-	-
<i>Constitutional values – Citizenship</i>	1	1	-	-
PC2. identify constitutional values, civic rights, duties, personal values and ethics and environmentally sustainable practices	-	-	-	-
<i>Becoming a Professional in the 21st Century</i>	1	3	-	-
PC3. explain 21st Century Skills such as Self-Awareness, Behavior Skills, Positive attitude, self-motivation, problem-solving, creative thinking, time management, social and cultural awareness, emotional awareness, continuous learning mindset etc.	-	-	-	-
<i>Basic English Skills</i>	2	3	-	-
PC4. speak with others using some basic English phrases or sentences	-	-	-	-
<i>Communication Skills</i>	1	1	-	-
PC5. follow good manners while communicating with others	-	-	-	-
PC6. work with others in a team	-	-	-	-
<i>Diversity & Inclusion</i>	1	1	-	-
PC7. communicate and behave appropriately with all genders and PwD	-	-	-	-
PC8. report any issues related to sexual harassment	-	-	-	-
<i>Financial and Legal Literacy</i>	3	4	-	-
PC9. use various financial products and services safely and securely	-	-	-	-

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Assessment Criteria for Outcomes	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks
PC10. calculate income, expenses, savings etc.	-	-	-	-
PC11. approach the concerned authorities for any exploitation as per legal rights and laws	-	-	-	-
<i>Essential Digital Skills</i>	4	6	-	-
PC12. operate digital devices and use its features and applications securely and safely	-	-	-	-
PC13. use internet and social media platforms securely and safely	-	-	-	-
<i>Entrepreneurship</i>	3	5	-	-
PC14. identify and assess opportunities for potential business	-	-	-	-
PC15. identify sources for arranging money and associated financial and legal challenges	-	-	-	-
<i>Customer Service</i>	2	2	-	-
PC16. identify different types of customers	-	-	-	-
PC17. identify customer needs and address them appropriately	-	-	-	-
PC18. follow appropriate hygiene and grooming standards	-	-	-	-
<i>Getting ready for apprenticeship & Jobs</i>	1	3	-	-
PC19. create a basic biodata	-	-	-	-
PC20. search for suitable jobs and apply	-	-	-	-
PC21. identify and register apprenticeship opportunities as per requirement	-	-	-	-
NOS Total	20	30	-	-

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National Occupational Standards (NOS) Parameters

NOS Code	DGT/VSQ/N0101
NOS Name	Employability Skills (30 Hours)
Sector	Cross Sectoral
Sub-Sector	Professional Skills
Occupation	Employability
NSQF Level	2
Credits	1
Version	1.0
Last Reviewed Date	12/03/2026
Next Review Date	12/03/2029
NSQC Clearance Date	12/03/2026

Assessment Guidelines and Assessment Weightage

Assessment Guidelines

1. Criteria for assessment for each Qualification Pack will be created by the Sector Skill Council. Each Element/ Performance Criteria (PC) will be assigned marks proportional to its importance in NOS. SSC will also lay down proportion of marks for Theory and Skills Practical for each Element/ PC.
2. The assessment for the theory part will be based on knowledge bank of questions created by the SSC.
3. Assessment will be conducted for all compulsory NOS, and where applicable, on the selected elective/option NOS/set of NOS.
4. Individual assessment agencies will create unique question papers for theory part for each candidate at each examination/training center (as per assessment criteria below).
5. Individual assessment agencies will create unique evaluations for skill practical for every student at each examination/ training center based on these criteria.
6. To pass the Qualification Pack assessment, every trainee should score the Recommended Pass % aggregate for the QP.
7. In case of unsuccessful completion, the trainee may seek reassessment on the Qualification Pack.

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Minimum Aggregate Passing % at QP Level : 70

(Please note: Every Trainee should score a minimum aggregate passing percentage as specified above, to successfully clear the Qualification Pack assessment.)

Assessment Weightage

Compulsory NOS

National Occupational Standards	Theory Marks	Practical Marks	Project Marks	Viva Marks	Total Marks	Weightage
HCS/N2915.Introduction to Usta or Gesso Painting	75	25	0	0	100	10
HCS/N2914.Tools, Materials & Base Surfaces in Usta Painting	31	69	0	0	100	10
HCS/N2917.Identify and Understand Design Motifs and Patterns in Usta Painting	40	60	0	0	100	10
HCS/N2916.Traditional and Contemporary Techniques of Usta Painting	25	75	0	0	100	10
HCS/N2918.Understand the Process of Product Development in Usta Painting	32	68	0	0	100	10
HCS/N2919.Quality Standards and Packaging in Usta Painting	40	60	0	0	100	10
HCS/N2920.Sustainability and Waste management in Usta Painting	25	75	0	0	100	10
HCS/N2913.Entrepreneurship skills for Usta Craft Artisan	35	65	0	0	100	10
HCS/N9901.Coordinate with colleagues and work as a team	35	65	-	-	100	10
DGT/VSQ/N0101.Employability Skills (30 Hours)	20	30	-	-	50	10
Total	358	592	-	-	950	100

Qualification Pack

Acronyms

NOS	National Occupational Standard(s)
NSQF	National Skills Qualifications Framework
QP	Qualifications Pack
TVET	Technical and Vocational Education and Training

Qualification Pack

Glossary

Sector	Sector is a conglomeration of different business operations having similar business and interests. It may also be defined as a distinct subset of the economy whose components share similar characteristics and interests.
Sub-sector	Sub-sector is derived from a further breakdown based on the characteristics and interests of its components.
Occupation	Occupation is a set of job roles, which perform similar/ related set of functions in an industry.
Job role	Job role defines a unique set of functions that together form a unique employment opportunity in an organisation.
Occupational Standards (OS)	OS specify the standards of performance an individual must achieve when carrying out a function in the workplace, together with the Knowledge and Understanding (KU) they need to meet that standard consistently. Occupational Standards are applicable both in the Indian and global contexts.
Performance Criteria (PC)	Performance Criteria (PC) are statements that together specify the standard of performance required when carrying out a task.
National Occupational Standards (NOS)	NOS are occupational standards which apply uniquely in the Indian context.
Qualifications Pack (QP)	QP comprises the set of OS, together with the educational, training and other criteria required to perform a job role. A QP is assigned a unique qualifications pack code.
Unit Code	Unit code is a unique identifier for an Occupational Standard, which is denoted by an 'N'
Unit Title	Unit title gives a clear overall statement about what the incumbent should be able to do.
Description	Description gives a short summary of the unit content. This would be helpful to anyone searching on a database to verify that this is the appropriate OS they are looking for.
Scope	Scope is a set of statements specifying the range of variables that an individual may have to deal with in carrying out the function which have a critical impact on quality of performance required.

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Knowledge and Understanding (KU)	Knowledge and Understanding (KU) are statements which together specify the technical, generic, professional and organisational specific knowledge that an individual needs in order to perform to the required standard.
Organisational Context	Organisational context includes the way the organisation is structured and how it operates, including the extent of operative knowledge managers have of their relevant areas of responsibility.
Technical Knowledge	Technical knowledge is the specific knowledge needed to accomplish specific designated responsibilities.
Core Skills/ Generic Skills (GS)	Core skills or Generic Skills (GS) are a group of skills that are the key to learning and working in today's world. These skills are typically needed in any work environment in today's world. These skills are typically needed in any work environment. In the context of the OS, these include communication related skills that are applicable to most job roles.
Electives	Electives are NOS/set of NOS that are identified by the sector as contributive to specialization in a job role. There may be multiple electives within a QP for each specialized job role. Trainees must select at least one elective for the successful completion of a QP with Electives.
Options	Options are NOS/set of NOS that are identified by the sector as additional skills. There may be multiple options within a QP. It is not mandatory to select any of the options to complete a QP with Options.